

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>

<think>Reasoning process here :

1. ****Duration of symptoms****: The patient has been feeling sad for as long as he can remember , which suggests a chronic condition .
2. ****Cognitive symptoms****: The patient feels hopeless , has difficulty making decisions , and has worsening suicidal ideations , which are common symptoms of depression .
3. ****Psychotic symptoms****: The patient's belief that his life is cursed and that terrible things will happen to him if they don't , suggests a psychotic symptom , which is a common feature of depression .
4. ****Energy and concentration****: The patient reports decreased energy and concentration , which are common symptoms of depression .
5. ****Sleep and job functioning****: The patient is getting enough sleep and able to hold a job , which suggests that his symptoms are not severely impairing his daily functioning .
6. ****Lack of other symptoms****: There is no mention of mania , psychosis , or other symptoms that would suggest a different diagnosis , such as mania or psychosis .
7. ****Comorbidities****: The patient's symptoms are not accompanied by other symptoms that would suggest a different diagnosis , such as paranoid personality disorder .

Based on these observations , the patient's symptoms are most consistent with major depressive disorder (MDD), also known as double depression when it is accompanied by a history of depression . Double depression is a subtype of MDD characterized by the presence of depressive symptoms and suicidal ideations.</think>